



STEVE REDGRAVE

Winning a medal at the Olympics is the dream of any athlete. But to sustain that interest over 20 years is not something most are capable of. Steve Redgrave defied age and diabetes to place himself at the top of the pantheon of Olympic champions with a fifth straight one. Starting with Los Angeles 1984 through to Sydney 2000, he rowed his way to glory, his final win coming after he had announced his retirement following his fourth gold: "If anyone sees me going anywhere near a boat again, they have my permission to shoot me!" The Briton's tryst with Olympic stardom got off to a start in Los Angeles as part of the winning coxed fours before getting to Seoul 1988, where Redgrave, in the company of Andy Holmes, took gold in the coxless pairs and bronze in the coxed pairs. By the time he got to Barcelona in 1992, Redgrave knew very well when to dominate the rival crews and when to hold back. This helped him and his new partner, Matthew Pinset, take pole position and repeat the feat at Atlanta 1996, where Redgrave was the British flagbearer as well. In Sydney, he was seen in action in the coxed fours, which Britain won, giving Redgrave his fifth consecutive gold medal.

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